



## ADOPTION PLANNER • NINETY DAYS

# The 90-Day Small-Business AI Adoption *Planner*

A smaller business does not need a three-year programme. It needs ninety controlled days that build evidence, capability and momentum. Work the three phases in order, and assign an owner to every line.

## DAYS 1 TO 30 Understand

Get an honest picture before you touch a tool. Almost every failed adoption skipped this.

|                          |                                                                                                                               |                |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Agree the leadership objective<br>What is AI in service of? One sentence everything later is judged against.                  | OWNER<br>_____ |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Surface the AI already in use<br>Including the quiet, unofficial kind. Without blame: it is your best evidence of what helps. | OWNER<br>_____ |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Run a light risk discovery<br>What data must never be pasted in, and where a confident wrong answer could do harm.            | OWNER<br>_____ |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | List candidate workflows<br>The frequent, worthwhile, checkable tasks where AI is likely to help.                             | OWNER<br>_____ |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Take a baseline measure<br>How long the chosen work takes today, or how often it goes wrong. No baseline, no proof later.     | OWNER<br>_____ |

### BY THE END OF PHASE ONE

A one-sentence objective, a map of current use, a written data rule, a shortlist of workflows, and a **baseline you can measure against.**



DAYS 31 TO 60 **Build**

One or two pieces of work actually change. Two is a deliberate ceiling, not a starting point.

|                          |                                                                                                                                                                      |                |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> | <b>Select no more than two use cases</b><br>The best balance of value and low risk from your phase-one shortlist.                                                    | OWNER<br>_____ |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | <b>Create reusable instructions and context</b><br>The standing prompt, house style, examples and definitions, so the work is owned by the business, not one person. | OWNER<br>_____ |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | <b>Test with a small group</b><br>Include someone sceptical, not just the enthusiasts.                                                                               | OWNER<br>_____ |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | <b>Record the failures honestly</b><br>They are the most valuable output of the month: they show where human checks belong.                                          | OWNER<br>_____ |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | <b>Establish human approval</b><br>Which outputs a person must check, and who that person is, before anything goes live.                                             | OWNER<br>_____ |

**BY THE END OF PHASE TWO**

One or two workflows running on **reusable, owned instructions**, tested by real people, with the failure modes known and the human checks placed.



DAYS 61 TO 90 **Adopt**

Decide whether this survives contact with normal working life.

|                          |                                                                                                                     |                |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> | <b>Train the people who do the work</b><br>Use your own real examples from the build phase, not a generic course.   | OWNER<br>_____ |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | <b>Formalise the workflow</b><br>Write the short version of how it now runs, so it does not live only in one head.  | OWNER<br>_____ |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | <b>Measure results against the baseline</b><br>Be honest if the answer is disappointing. That honesty is the point. | OWNER<br>_____ |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | <b>Assign ownership</b><br>A named person responsible for keeping the workflow healthy as the tools change.         | OWNER<br>_____ |

THEN DECIDE, FOR EACH USE CASE

|                                                                                     |                                                                                       |                                                                                         |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Stop</b><br>It did not earn its place. Say so plainly and free up the attention. | <b>Improve</b><br>Promising but not there. Run another short cycle on the weak point. | <b>Scale</b><br>It worked. Widen it deliberately, with the checks and ownership intact. |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

Discuss a 90-Day Adoption Build

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